

100 Days of Linux - Day 073

Title: Downloading Files with wget

Today's Goal

Learn how to download files from the internet using the wget command.

Why This Matters

System administrators, developers and data engineers use wget to download datasets, software packages, logs and backup files directly from servers.

Command of the Day

Syntax: wget <URL>

Common options: -O (save with a custom name), -c (resume download), -q (quiet mode).

Examples:

```
wget https://example.com/file.txt
```

```
wget -O report.html https://example.com
```

```
wget -c https://example.com/bigfile.zip
```

Beginner Lesson

The wget command downloads files from websites and saves them to your current directory. Unlike curl, wget is mainly designed for downloading and can resume interrupted downloads.

Practice Questions

1. Download a sample file using wget.
2. Save a downloaded webpage as homepage.html using -O.
3. Resume an interrupted download using -c.
4. Download a file in quiet mode using -q.
5. Verify that the downloaded files exist using ls.

Hints

Use ls to confirm downloads. Use -O for a custom filename and -c if the download stops before completion.

Mini Challenge

Download two different files, rename one with -O and confirm both files are present in your current directory.

Common Mistakes

Using an invalid URL, forgetting the output filename after -O, or expecting wget to display webpage content in the terminal.

Did You Know?

wget can also mirror entire websites for offline viewing when used with advanced options.

Pro Tip

Use wget -c for large downloads so you can continue from where the download stopped.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: wget https://example.com/file.txt

Q2: wget -O homepage.html https://example.com

Q3: wget -c https://example.com/bigfile.zip

Q4: wget -q https://example.com/file.txt

Q5: ls

Homework

Download three publicly available files using wget and organise them inside a folder named downloads_practice.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you will learn how to connect securely to remote Linux systems using the ssh command.